

## TEN CENTURIES ARE NOT REPRESENTATIVE OF THE TRUE STATE OF AFFAIRS AT THE TIME.

To conclude, I trust that the reader will not consider me to be unreasonable if I request that henceforth all informed persons cease and desist from calling Family 35 (**K<sup>r</sup>**) a revision at any time. Enough is enough!  
**Down with canards!**

### Von Soden's treatment of his **K<sup>r</sup>**

I have been criticized because I have never answered, in an organized way, von Soden's 'arguments' whereby he called his **K<sup>r</sup>** a late revision—I never did for him what I did for Hort. Since there are people today who still think that his 'arguments' are valid, I recognize that I should have. I appealed to Dr. Jakob van Bruggen for help with von Soden. He began his answer by saying that von Soden "makes statements and gives descriptions, but doesn't give arguments or proofs". Well now, how is it possible to refute 'arguments' that do not exist? But since an answer of some sort is being called for, I will evaluate the 'statements'.

1. Von Soden noted that there were relatively few **K<sup>r</sup>** MSS in the libraries of Western Europe, probably true. But he went on to opine that it was a negative circumstance, a point against **K<sup>r</sup>**.<sup>1</sup> He seems to have forgotten that until the Protestant Reformation the Roman Church dominated Western Europe, and that church used Latin, not Greek. Worse still, only the Pope could interpret the Scriptures, and only the clergy were permitted to even read them. The common people, the laity, were forbidden to do so. So in the 14<sup>th</sup> century, who in all of Western Europe would have any use for Greek MSS? They were curiosities, museum pieces, to be found only in libraries or museums. All the NT MSS in those libraries came from the east. The British Museum (now Library) has a considerable collection; how did it get them? They were donated by travelers who had bought them in the east. All said and done, I submit to the reader that the number of **K<sup>r</sup>** MSS in the west is irrelevant to the age and nature of the text-type, and should not be adduced.
2. Von Soden repeatedly mentioned the well-known fact that the **K<sup>r</sup>** MSS are characterized by an elaborate liturgical apparatus in the margins, including 'begin' and 'end' written within the Text itself, but in ink of a different color, usually red, so the reader would know

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<sup>1</sup> Soden, Hermann F. von. *Die Schriften des Neuen Testaments*. 2 vols. Göttingen: Vandenhoeck und Ruprecht, 1911, pages 757-765. (His German is difficult to read.)